

Electronics Development Fund expected soon

Central government's Electronics Manufacturing Policy proposed a fund of \$1641.49 million as Electronic Development Fund to boost the domestic electronic systems design and manufacturing (ESDM) capacity. The fund is now set to be rolled out within a couple of months. Government aims to promote innovation, intellectual property, research and development and nanoelectronics through this fund. The fund will also help to commercialise made in India products and focus on minimising imports.

A senior official associated with the ministry for Industry Promotion in ESDM sector said, "The secretary in the Department of Electronics and IT (DeitY) had forwarded the guidelines on the fund's corpus among others to the ministry and we expect cabinet approval soon." He added that a recent cabinet note on policy was influenced by market dynamics and ministry is keen on promoting this fund at least up to 2020.

The proposal for setting up this fund dates back to 2005 but it faced a lot of hurdles. The recent hurdle was created by Investment Promotion Cell (IPC) of IT ministry which said, "Adequate justification had not been provided to set up the venture capital fund for electronic ecosystem development."

DeitY proposed distribution of this fund for various activities. It expected 25 to 49 per cent of the fund for seed purpose, early growth stage activities in electronics and technology acquisition. Similarly, it proposed 25 per cent of the fund for development of electronic ecosystem and manufacturing.

However, IPC still believes that 100 percent government-supported venture capital fund cannot boost the private sector participation and wants

Manoj Verma joins NTL

Manoj Verma, having 32 years of experience with global leaders and MNCs, has taken over as the global president and director of NTL Lemnis. He will also be a member of the Advisory Board of NTL Electronics, the parent company. He started his career with Philips and after 17 years he moved to GE Lighting India to head their professional lighting business. He then worked with Osram India, Crompton Greaves and the CK Birla group as CEO of Orient Electric.

to include telecom department as one of its member of the funding board. DoT was a member of National Manufacturing Competitiveness Council and policy of DeitY has close link with manufacturing of telecom equipment.

Solar parks to host up to 20GW power

The government has plans to furnish low-cost loans and come up with solar power parks across the country to host about 20GW of capacity, which is ten times of what it has established to date. Speaking about the initiative, Tarun Kapoor, joint-secretary, Ministry of New and Renewable Energy said, "We are preparing a scheme for solar parks and it will be out after cabinet approval in about one month."

India is designing some of the world's largest photovoltaic plants as it attempts to bring the costs down and promote generation. It aims at producing power from about four ultra-mega projects at a peak of ₹ 5500 megawatt-hour, which is 32 per cent below the global average, as per the data accumulated by Bloomberg.

The parks will have large plants ranging between 500 to 1000MW power that will be affiliated to the grid. Government subsidies will maintain a very humble price of land within the parks, in order to control project costs, Kapoor said. State utilities will be asked to purchase at least 20 per cent of the power rendered at the parks. Project owners will be free to sell and send the balance to consumers elsewhere in the country.



Solar park

In Focus